
HS 623: Advance Social Psychology

Course Code	HS 623
Course Name	Advance Social Psychology
L-T-P-C	4-0-0-4
Prerequisites	Consent of the Course Instructor
Approval	9th Senate (May 2016)

Course Contents

NOTE: In the articles that report empirical studies, you are not required to understand details of statistical analysis. You need to understand only the major empirical findings, simple statistical indicators such as averages and correlation coefficients, and the main theoretical ideas discussed in these articles.

- **Topic 1: Social psychology as a branch of psychology** [4 Lectures]
 - Its historical background, major features of contemporary social psychology, and methods adopted in social psychology.
- **Readings:** Baron & Byrne (10th edition)
 - Social psychology: A working definition (pp. 5-13)
 - Answering questions about social behaviour and social thought: Research methods in social psychology (pp. 18-26) (Omit section Interpreting Research Results)
- **Topic 2: Social Influence.** [5 Lectures]
 - Social facilitation, social loafing, power, and authority.
- **Readings:**
 - Grant T. & Dajee, K. (2003). Types of tasks, types of audience, types of actor: Interaction between mere presence and personality type in a simple mathematical task. *Personality & Individual Differences*, 35, 633-639.
 - North, A. C.; Linley, P. A. & Hargreaves, D. J. (2000). Social loafing in a cooperative classroom task. *Education Psychology*, 20 (4), 389-392.
- **Topic 3: Distributive and Procedural Justice.** [4 Lectures]
 - Major concepts, theories. Determinants of justice perception and justice behaviour.
- **Readings:**
 - Blader, S. L. (2007). What determines peoples fairness judgements? Identification and outcomes influence procedural justice evaluations under uncertainty. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*, 43, 986-994.
- **Topic 4: Attitudes.** [5 Lectures]
 - Formation, measurement, and change. Theories and models of attitude change. Dynamics and strategies of persuasion.
- **Readings:** Baron & Byrne (10th edition).
 - Attitude formation: How and Why Attitudes Develop, 121-125, 127-140 (Omit Attitude functions).
 - Social learning: Acquiring attitudes from others; Genetic factors: Some surprising findings.
 - The attitude behaviour link: When and How Attitudes Influence Behaviour; The fine art of persuasion: Using Messages to Change Attitudes (Omit When attitude change fails).
- **Topic 5: Social Cognition.** [6 Lectures]
 - Attribution theories and attribution biases. Counterfactual thinking.
- **Readings:**

- Augoustinos & Walker (1995). Attributional biases. pp. 67-85 (Omit Self-serving Biases).
- Connolly, T. & Zeelenberg, M. (2002). Regret in decision-making. Current directions in Psychological Science, 11 (6), 212-216.
- **Topic 6: Self-esteem and its social context.** [6 Lectures]
- **Readings:** Baron & Byrne (10th edition).
 - Self-esteem: Attitudes about oneself, pp. 171-175. b) Other aspects of Self-functioning, pp. 175-183.
- **Topic 7: Social categorization and social identity intergroup relationships.** [6 Lectures]
- **Readings:**
 - a) Baron & Byrne (10th edition). Social categorization: The Us versus Them effect and the Ultimate Attribution Error, pp. 222-230 (Include: cognitive sources of prejudice; stereotypes: explicit and implicit; other cognitive mechanism in prejudice: illusory correlations and out-group homogeneity); (Omit Beyond the Headlines).
 - Majeed, A. & Ghosh, E. S. K. (1982). A study of social identity in three ethnic groups in India. International Journal of Psychology, 17, 455-463.
- **Topic 8: Group dynamics: Group cohesiveness; Group decision-making** [8 Lectures]
- **Readings:**
 - Alcock, Carment & Sadava (4th edition). Groups, pp. 332-338. (Include: groups, language and group identity, attraction to the group cohesiveness, group beliefs and their functions, differentiation within the group, role and status, regulation by the group: norms, group decision-making); (Omit Power).

Readings

1. Alcock, Carment & Sadava (4th edition). Groups, pp. 332-338. (Include: groups, language and group identity, attraction to the group cohesiveness, group beliefs and their functions, differentiation within the group, role and status, regulation by the group: norms, group decision-making) (Omit Power).
2. Attitude formation: How and Why Attitudes Develop, 121-125, 127-140 (Omit Attitude functions).
3. Augoustinos & Walker (1995). Attributional biases. pp. 67-85 (Omit Self-serving Biases).
4. Baron & Byrne, Social Psychology (10th edition).
5. Blader, S. L. (2007). What determines peoples fairness judgements? Identification and outcomes influence procedural justice evaluations under uncertainty. Journal of Experimental Social Psychology, 43, 986-994.
6. Connolly, T. & Zeelenberg, M. (2002). Regret in decision-making. Current directions in Psychological Science, 11 (6), 212-216.
7. Grant T. & Dajee, K. (2003). Types of tasks, types of audience, types of actor: Interaction between mere presence and personality type in a simple mathematical task. Personality & Individual Differences, 35, 633-639.
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